Prepflow

DAILY EDITION · FOR TONY DIBBIN

Wednesday, 21 October 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON	BIRMINGHAM	MANCHESTER	GLASGOW
Light rain	Light rain	Rain	Drizzle
12° 8°	11° 7°	12° 8°	10° 6°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1 **The latest Covid inquiry report finds government failings allowed the virus to 'spread like wildfire' in care homes.**

The sixth report from the inquiry criticises the shocking lack of PPE and the way patients were discharged from hospital. It suggests these issues contributed significantly to the spread of Covid-19.

HEALTH · UK

2 **The Sultan of Oman has arrived in the UK for a state visit, with the Royals rolling out the red carpet at Windsor.**

Oman is a key strategic partner in the Middle East, making this a significant diplomatic event. The visit includes formal receptions and discussions.

POLITICS · UK

3 **A long-awaited decision on the controversial Jackdaw gas field in the North Sea is expected to be announced today.**

This announcement by the UK government could have significant implications for energy policy and environmental targets. The field has been a subject of much debate.

ENERGY · UK

4 **Three children have been injured after a school bus had its roof ripped off in a crash in Wales.**

The bus was on its way to Ysgol Gyfun Gwent Is Coed when the incident occurred. The children are receiving hospital treatment.

ACCIDENT · UK

5 **Prince Harry has expressed a desire to 'reconcile' with his family, according to a recent magazine interview.**

The Duke of Sussex made the comments in an interview conducted last month in New York. It suggests a potential softening in relations with the Royal Family.

ROYALS · UK

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02 — SHOWBIZ

What's coming up

1 **Sir Paul McCartney and Ringo Starr are backing plans for a new immersive Beatles attraction in Liverpool.**

The surviving Beatles have welcomed the visitor experience, which is described as being 'like Graceland or Dollywood'. It's set to open in 2028, offering fans a deep dive into the band's history.

ON AIR — Are you excited for a new Beatles experience? What would you hope to see there?

MUSIC · 2028

2 **New unseen clips from the classic sitcom Only Fools and Horses are set to feature in a new show.**

The footage, from the iconic 'Jolly Boys' Outing' episode, promises to add new depth to the beloved series. Fans will get to see more of Del Boy and Rodney's adventures.

ON AIR — What's your favourite Only Fools and Horses episode or moment?

TV · COMING SOON

3 **Alice Cooper is reflecting on his faith, fame, and addiction ahead of a book tour appearance in Wolverhampton.**

The legendary rocker describes his stage persona as a character, 'like Jekyll and Hyde'. He'll be sharing insights from his life and career with fans.

ON AIR — What's your favourite Alice Cooper track, and why?

MUSIC · THIS WEEK

4 **Apu from The Simpsons is returning with a new voice after an eight-year absence from Springfield's airwaves.**

The much-loved Kwik-E-Mart owner has been seen but not heard for years due to a race row. His return is sure to spark conversation among fans.

ON AIR — Are you glad to see Apu back in The Simpsons, and do you think the new voice will work?

TV · COMING SOON

5 **If you're still wondering what to wear for Halloween, some popular costume trends are emerging for adults this year.**

Expect to see lots of 'Freaky Nikki', Dolly Parton, and whimsical gargoyle-inspired outfits. It's time to get creative with your spooky season attire!

ON AIR — What's the best Halloween costume you've ever worn or seen?

CULTURE · THIS WEEK

03 — SPORT

On the schedule

1 **Ronnie O'Sullivan faces a real battle to stay in the world's top 16, a prospect hard to imagine for snooker fans.**

The 'Rocket' has been a central figure at the Crucible for years, but his current form means his place in the elite could be at risk. It would be a World Championship without one of its biggest stars.

ON AIR — Could you imagine a World Snooker Championship without Ronnie O'Sullivan? What impact would that have?

SNOOKER · UK

2 **Tottenham Hotspur have secured their first Premier League win of the season, beating Coventry City.**

Spurs head coach Roberto de Zerbi praised his team's spirit and attitude despite admitting they 'lack confidence'. It's a much-needed boost for the struggling side.

ON AIR — After their first win, do you think Spurs can turn their season around?

FOOTBALL · UK

3 **Coventry City manager Frank Lampard says he's 'proud' of his side's performance, despite their defeat to Tottenham Hotspur.**

Lampard's team put up a strong fight against the struggling Premier League side. He highlighted the effort and determination shown by his players.

ON AIR — Despite the loss, does this performance give Coventry fans hope for the rest of the season?

FOOTBALL · UK

4 **Shane Lowry has made history by becoming the first player to be traded in the new TMRW Golf League (TGL).**

Lowry will be joining Rory McIlroy at Boston Common Golf for the 2027 season. This marks a new era for the golf league with its innovative trade system.

ON AIR — What do you make of the TGL's new trade system? Could it bring more excitement to golf?

GOLF · UK

5 **James Maddison provided the moment of magic Tottenham needed in their 3-1 victory against Coventry.**

On his first start since May 2025, Maddison delivered a superb performance, proving his worth to the team. It was a long-awaited return to form for the midfielder.

ON AIR — How important is James Maddison to Tottenham's success this season?

FOOTBALL · UK

04 — NEWSBRIEF

Quick hits

1 **The delightful art of 'doodling while on the phone' is making a comeback as a legitimate way to boost creativity and focus.**

Research suggests that those little scribbles we make during conversations aren't just idle distraction; they can actually help us process information better and even come up with new ideas. So next time you're on a long call, grab a pen and paper!

2 **A surprising new trend involves people collecting and displaying 'unusual pebbles' found on their local walks.**

It seems the humble stone, often overlooked, is now being appreciated for its unique shapes, colours, and textures. From perfectly smooth river stones to craggy, interesting coastal finds, these natural treasures are becoming quirky home decorations.

3 **The simple pleasure of 'untangling a knot' is being celebrated as a small but satisfying victory in daily life.**

Whether it's a necklace, a ball of string, or even earphone wires, successfully unravelling a tricky tangle provides a real sense of accomplishment. It's a tiny moment of order restored in a chaotic world.

4 **Experts are suggesting that the comforting sound of 'rain on a windowpane' is one of nature's best stress relievers.**

The gentle, rhythmic pitter-patter can lower heart rates and promote relaxation, making it a natural background sound for unwinding. It's almost like nature's own lullaby.

5 **There's a growing appreciation for the distinct and earthy scent of 'freshly turned soil' in gardens and allotments.**

This particular aroma is being recognised for its grounding and calming properties, connecting us to nature even in urban settings. Gardeners rejoice, your hard work smells wonderful!

6 **The satisfying 'thunk' of a well-poured pint of milk landing perfectly in the fridge door is gaining recognition as a domestic delight.**

It's a small, everyday sound that signals organisation and a well-stocked kitchen. That moment of perfect placement can bring a surprising amount of quiet satisfaction.

7 **A new movement is encouraging people to embrace the joy of 're-reading favourite books' for comfort and new insights.**

Rather than constantly seeking out new material, revisiting beloved stories offers a sense of familiarity and allows readers to discover details they might have missed the first time around. It's like catching up with an old friend.

05 — TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q **Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to quietly 'doing' what when we open a new packet of biscuits, even if we know it's not strictly necessary, to ensure peak enjoyment?**

ANSWER: LOOKING AT ALL THE BISCUITS, THEN SELECTING THE ONE WITH THE FEWEST CRUMBS OR IMPERFECTIONS, SAVING IT FOR LAST.

Q **Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to having a particular 'odd routine' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a new, fancy bar of soap, especially if it's a particularly fragrant one. What is it?**

ANSWER: TAKING A REALLY DEEP SNIFF AND ADMIRING THE PACKAGING FOR A GOOD MINUTE, THEN PLACING IT PERFECTLY IN THE SOAP DISH.

TALK TOPIC

- **You know how sometimes a particular 'everyday pattern' just catches your eye – maybe the way a shadow falls, or the arrangement of items on a shelf, or even the brickwork on a building?**
  What's an unexpected pattern or visual detail that you've noticed recently, and what made it stand out to you?

- **We all have that 'one small, everyday household item' that, for some reason, we're surprisingly protective of or attached to, even if it's just a favourite mug or a well-loved spatula.**
  What's that treasured, perhaps a bit quirky, everyday item in your home, and what makes it so special to you?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY — LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** A group of owls is called a parliament.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** The chameleon is the only reptile that can move its eyes independently in two different directions, but it can't change colour.

06 — LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£4.3 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£4.3 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 — FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The British Isles are home to over 10,000 miles of coastline, offering a huge variety of beaches and cliffs.
- The 'richest' soil on Earth is called 'chernozem', found in regions like Ukraine and Russia, and is incredibly fertile.
- The distinctive sound of Big Ben's chimes is officially known as the 'Westminster Quarters'.
- Honey never spoils and can be safe to eat even after thousands of years.
- A pineapple is not a single fruit, but rather a collection of many individual berries fused together.
- The world's oldest known living tree, 'Methuselah', is a Great Basin bristlecone pine over 4,800 years old.
- The 'king' of playing cards is the only one without a moustache.
- The Eiffel Tower can be 15 cm taller during the summer due to thermal expansion of the iron.

08 — TODAY'S DAY NOTES WED 21 OCT 2026

On this day

Day 294 of the year, 71 days left in 2026. Today Armed Forces Day (Honduras); Christian feast day: Céline of Laon; Christian feast day: Blessed Charles of Austria (Roman Catholic Church); Christian feast day: Fintán of Taghmon. Star sign Libra, birthstone Opal.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1940 — Geoffrey Boycott, English cricketer and sportscaster
- 1991 — Harry Pell, English footballer
- 1978 — Will Estes, American actor
- 1976 — Josh Ritter, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1991 — Rob Keogh, English cricketer
- 1943 — Ron Elliott, American singer-songwriter, guitarist, and composer
- 1959 — Melora Walters, American actress, director, and writer
- 1980 — Brian Pittman, American bass player

THE DAY TODAY

- 1973 — Fred Dryer of the Los Angeles Rams becomes the first player in NFL history to score two safeties in the same game.
- 1979 — Moshe Dayan resigns from the Israeli government because of strong disagreements with Prime Minister Menachem Begin over policy towards the Arabs.
- 1994 — North Korea and the United States sign an Agreed Framework that requires North Korea to stop its nuclear weapons program and agree to inspections.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1971 — A gas explosion kills 22 people at a shopping centre near Glasgow, Scotland.
- 2021 — A shooting occurs on the set of the film Rust, in which actor Alec Baldwin discharged a prop weapon which had been loaded, killing the director of photography, Halyna Hutchins, and injuring director Joel Souza.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1950 — Korean War: Heavy fighting begins between British and Australian forces and North Koreans during the Battle of Yongju.

- 1969 — The 1969 Somali coup d'état establishes a Marxist–Leninist administration.
- 1967 — The National Mobilization Committee to End the War in Vietnam organizes a march of fifty thousand people from the Lincoln Memorial to the Pentagon.

09 — TOMORROW'S DAY NOTES THU 22 OCT 2026

A peek at tomorrow

Day 295 of the year, 70 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Abercius of Hieropolis; Christian feast day: Cordula of Cologne; Christian feast day: Donatus of Fiesole; Christian feast day: Marcus of Jerusalem. Star sign Libra, birthstone Opal.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1968 — Shelby Lynne, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1986 — Chancellor, South Korean-American musician
- 1992 — Sofia Vassilieva, American actress
- 1958 — Bobby Blotzer, American drummer
- 1990 — Jonathan Lipnicki, American actor
- 1949 — Stiv Bators, American singer-songwriter, guitarist, and actor (died 1990)
- 1981 — Michael Fishman, American actor and producer
- 1980 — Niall Breslin, Irish singer-songwriter, guitarist, producer, and footballer

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 2007 — A raid on Anuradhapura Air Force Base is carried out by 21 Tamil Tiger commandos, with all except one dying in this attack. Eight Sri Lanka Air Force planes are destroyed and ten damaged.
- 1987 — John Adams' opera Nixon in China premiered at the Houston Grand Opera.
- 1999 — Maurice Papon, an official in the Vichy government during World War II, is jailed for crimes against humanity.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 2005 — Bellview Airlines Flight 210 crashes in Nigeria, killing all 117 people on board.
- 2008 — India launches its first uncrewed lunar probe mission Chandrayaan-1.

10 — FORWARD PLANNING · FILM

Coming to cinemas

OCTOBER 2026 · PREVIEW

FRI 23 Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING · SPORT

On the sporting calendar

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